

SUSPENSE



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commercial team or move to the business development aspect of the service. Under the technical path, you can start off as a software engineer and grow to the highest level of a chief technical officer. If you choose the managerial path, you can grow to the level of a business line head.

What's in demand?

Let's talk about the sector expectations now. Though the Indian engineering institutes are churning out thousands of technical graduates every year, only 25 to 30 per cent are employable. There is a significant gap between the need of the sector and what the fresh engineering graduates bring to the table. Recruiters generally look at a combination of a consistent academic record and soft skills.

"When it comes to hiring an engineer, a company looks for a candidate who possesses an engineering degree, preferably a specialisation in electronics and communication from a reputed college. Also, if a candidate possesses work experience with a telecom operator, or active or passive telecom infrastructure company, it adds to his credentials," Grover mentions.

Johar adds, "As an organisation, we focus to get right fit for the job. We capture the competencies required to perform in a given role, which include not only technical competencies but also business as well as human competencies. We hire engineers who are specialised in electronics and communication, or telecom, and also extend the scope to IT and computer science graduates."

Ericsson hires graduates for all domains like manufacturing and managed services, remote infrastructure management, R&D and network operations centre. The company also provides engineering students with internships in various departments under different project mentors across different domains. This helps the students get an exposure and also have hands-on-work-experience with Ericsson.

"The internship not only provides them with the basic training on various

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telecom architectures but also brings forth the real working scenario of the telecommunication field," Johar informs.

Handy tips

It is important to be a part of any live project that follows the recent sector trend, rather than confining yourself to the textbooks. You should start from the base level as an aspiring professional. Even professionals with engineering background often go through specialised training in theory and practice for optimising telecom applications. The training enables them to properly handle different types of machines and instruments used in various systems of telecom equipment, both in wired and wireless communication.

As telecom networks traverse multiple cultures, diverse terrains and extreme climates, the sector opens up a plethora of exciting work opportunities for aspirants. ●

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